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WITHDRAWAL SYMPTOMS

By M.G. Arun

Illustration by **NILANJAN DAS**

In a move reminiscent of the Narendra Modi-led BJP government's demonetisation exercise in November 2016, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) on May 19 said it is planning to withdraw currency notes of Rs 2,000 denomination from circulation, and that the public will be able to exchange these notes or deposit them at banks until September 30. A person can exchange Rs 2,000 notes worth Rs 20,000 at a time at any bank, the central bank elaborated. The long window of roughly four months that the RBI gave to exchange or deposit these notes is starkly different from the previous avatar of demonetisation where Rs 500 and Rs 1,000 notes were withdrawn overnight. However, the confusion around the announcement and the ensuing clarifications were